

THE EL PASO TIMES, Saturday

For First WAC Win

Miners Rally Past Lobos In Ninth Inning

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Times Sports Writer

The University of Texas at El Paso dugout went into pandemonium Friday afternoon at Dudley Field and with good reason.

Having suffered through 15 consecutive Western Athletic Conference setbacks without a victory, the Miners broke loose for two runs with two outs in the bottom of the ninth inning to defeat New Mexico's Lobos 2-1.

U.T. El Paso's triumph

seemed almost not to be as the Miners were down to their last out. Coach Andy Cohen sent right-handed hitting Roy Stringer to the plate and, after having two strikes going against him, the pinch-hitter drilled an opposite-field home run to right-center field to keep the contest going.

Joey Pennies continued to bombard New Mexico starter and loser Jim Weber with a double off the fence in left. Keith Rushing, who had been

held hitless by Weber his three previous trips to the plate, fouled off four or five pitches before hitting a high fly to left.

Lobo outfielder Phil Strassle raced back to the wall and attempted a game-saving leaping catch against the fence. But Rushing's hit was too high up the wall and Pennies trotted home with the victory as the Miner dugout emptied onto the field to congratulate Pennies and Rushing.

"Boy, this is just like winning the pennant," declared Cohen with a wide grin covering his face. "This was a great game to win and it's as good a game as I've ever seen played."

Miner starter Jeff Hogan won his second game of the season as the big, husky right-hander pitched the entire nine innings while allowing seven hits and two bases on balls while striking out three Lobos.

"You have to give Hogan credit," praised the Miner skipper. "Jeff had good stuff today and always kept the ball around the plate. It would have been a shame if he had lost a 1-0 decision."

New Mexico's lone run was recorded off Hogan in the eighth inning. Strassle singled with no outs and was moved to second base by Bill Smith's sacrifice bunt in front of home plate.

Strassle then took third on a passed ball by Miner catcher Joe Dehn and scored when Ron Smith slashed a single between third and short as Cohen had his infield drawn in for a possible play at the plate.

For all the seniors on the U.T. El Paso team, Friday's victory will probably remain in their minds much longer than all the other WAC defeats.

"This is great, we finally won a game and we really deserve

it," commented Pennies who actually scored the winning run. "Now all we have to do is win a couple Saturday."

The Miners and Lobos conclude their 1975 baseball seasons beginning at 11 a.m. Saturday at Dudley Field with U.T. El Paso holding a chance at catching New Mexico for third place in the WAC Southern Division behind Arizona State and Arizona.

New Mexico currently holds a 3-13 WAC record and 26-22 overall mark while the Miners are 1-15 in conference play and 16-26 for the entire year. Two victories in Saturday's doubleheader would pull U.T. El Paso into a two-way tie with the Lobos with identical 3-15 WAC records.

"It'd sure be nice if we could

finish the season with a three-game Western Athletic Conference win streak," said Cohen. "It would be a great carryover into next year."

Dave Jannusch will work the first game for the Miners while either Steve Day or Sam Cox going the second game.



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THE
ACTION
COAST
TO
COAST

OFF TRACK
BETTING (OTB)
MAJOR U.S.
HORSE TRACKS

GOLDEN GATE

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his heat with a 9.7, Charley Wells of Arizona State had 9.6 and Steve Williams, ASU, 9.6.

Colin Thurton finished sixth with a 9.8 clocking.

Reid, or "Cool" as his teammates call him, flashed to a 21.0 in the 220-yard dash and qualified. Charley Wells again led Reid with a 20.8 with Wardell Gilbreath of Arizona at 20.9. Williams and Brown led the other heat with 20.6 and 20.7, respectively, with another ASU runner, Randy Wagner, in third.

Tom Asare finished fourth in the long jump event with a 24-9. Darryl Hughes and Mike Haynes of ASU, finished 1-2 as expected with 25-1 and 24-11, respectively. Skip Peterson from New Mexico was third with 24-10.

The 880-yard run was not up to par, with Joe Giechoner reaching the finals in his heat, with the veteran Cummings of BYU catching Frank Munene about 20 yards

make it into the top four and qualify

ASU had two hurdlers qualified in the 120s, BYU only one. Favored Mel Powers of New Mexico was disqualified for false starting.

Herman Frazier and mates Julius Fletcher and Clifton McKenzie from ASU reach the 440-yard dash finals. BYU sends Saimoni Tamani to Saturday's battle.

In the intermediate hurdles, ASU again figures well, with two runners qualified, BYU has one.

On tap Saturday are the javelin finals where Tom Cashon must nose out the dominating Cougars from BYU, figured to cop 1-2-3. Hans Hoglund is a shoo-in for his third straight shot put title with teammate Almstrom a runnerup choice and Larry Jessee is the pick in the pole vault with Peter Tracy a strong contender to add on some points.

In the triple jump Arnold Grimes will have some tough competition and Greg Joy in the high jump, but both could be 10-

Cubs Give Padres

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